



Senate

General Assembly

File No. 480

February Session, 2026

Substitute Senate Bill No. 479

Senate, April 7, 2026

The Committee on Human Services reported through SEN. LESSER of the 9th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the Senate, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT CONCERNING OVERSIGHT OF FEDERAL FUND APPLICATIONS BY THE DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL SERVICES.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. (NEW) (*Effective from passage*) (a) As used in this section, (1)
2 "Rural Health Transformation Program" means a federal program
3 established pursuant to P.L. 119-21 that provides grants to states to
4 improve the health of rural residents; and (2) "technical assistance
5 funding" means federal grants to states to implement system
6 modifications to implement eligibility changes for certain public
7 assistance programs, including, but not limited to, Medicaid required
8 pursuant to P.L. 119-21.

9 (b) Not later than thirty days before submitting an application for
10 Rural Health Transformation Program grants or for technical assistance
11 funding, the Commissioner of Social Services shall forward such
12 application to the joint standing committee of the General Assembly
13 having cognizance of matters relating to human services. The committee
14 may schedule a public hearing on such application and vote on whether

15 to approve, deny or modify the application.

16 (c) If the committee does not vote to approve, deny or modify such
17 application not later than thirty days after receipt of such application
18 from the commissioner, the application shall be deemed approved. If
19 the committee votes to deny the application, the commissioner shall not
20 submit such application to the federal government. If the committee
21 votes to modify the application, the commissioner shall modify the
22 application in accordance with the committee's vote before submission
23 to the federal government.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	New section

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Subsec. (a)(1), "grant program" was changed to "program" and "to be distributed" was changed to "that provides grants" for clarity.

HS *Joint Favorable Subst. -LCO*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Social Services, Dept.	Federal Funds - See Below	See Below	See Below

Note: GF=General Fund

Municipal Impact: None

Explanation

The bill requires the Department of Social Services (DSS) to submit any application for Rural Health Transformation Program grants or technical assistance funding to the Human Services Committee at least 30 days before submitting it for federal approval. DSS cannot submit the application if the committee votes to deny it, or must submit a revised application if the committee votes to modify it.

To the extent this delays or modifies funding that DSS would have otherwise received, the state could experience a fiscal impact that cannot be determined at this time.

The Out Years

The annualized ongoing fiscal impact identified above would continue into the future subject to certain federal grant opportunities and related committee actions.

OLR Bill Analysis**sSB 479*****AN ACT CONCERNING OVERSIGHT OF FEDERAL FUND APPLICATIONS BY THE DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL SERVICES.*****SUMMARY**

This bill requires the Department of Social Services (DSS) to forward to the Human Services Committee any application for Rural Health Transformation Program (see BACKGROUND) grants or technical assistance funding at least 30 days before submitting it for federal approval. Under the bill, “technical assistance funding” means federal grants to implement system modifications to change eligibility for certain public assistance programs, such as Medicaid.

The bill authorizes the Human Services Committee to hold a public hearing on the application and vote to approve, deny, or modify it. If the committee does not vote on an application within 30 days after receiving it, it is deemed approved.

The bill also (1) prohibits DSS from submitting the application for federal approval if the committee votes to deny it and (2) requires DSS to modify the application before submitting it for federal approval if the committee votes to do so.

EFFECTIVE DATE: Upon passage

BACKGROUND***Rural Health Transformation Program***

Under this program, created under 2025 federal legislation (P.L. 119-21, § 71401), the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services is giving all states grants to implement measures intended to expand rural health care access and quality.

Connecticut is receiving a first-year grant of \$154 million under the program. DSS will serve as the lead agency under the grant funding, collaborating with several other agencies to implement projects across four initiatives: population health outcomes, workforce, data and technology, and care transformation and stability.

Related Bill

sSB 93 (File 44), favorably reported by the Public Health Committee, allows the Department of Public Health (DPH), or its licensing boards or commissions, to take disciplinary action against a practitioner who fails to fulfill any obligation resulting from receiving DPH funding under the Rural Health Transformation Program.

COMMITTEE ACTION

Human Services Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 16 Nay 7 (03/19/2026)